17.4 Asthma in Children

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Child says • "My chest feels tight." **Objective** • Wheeze, RR 40/min • Can only say a few words at a time • SpO_2 92%	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective breathing pattern** related to bronchospasm as evidenced by wheeze, tachypnea and difficulty speaking.	Within 2 hours, talks in full sentences and SpO_2 is 94% or more.	• Give the inhaled bronchodilator by spacer or nebuliser, as prescribed. • Give oral or IV steroid as prescribed. • Give oxygen to the SpO_2 target. • Keep the child sitting up and calm, with the parent.	Breathing better: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother says • "I am not sure how to use the spacer." **Objective** • Uses the spacer the wrong way • Has missed preventer doses	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge (parent)** related to inhaler and spacer use as evidenced by incorrect technique.	Before discharge, the parent uses the spacer correctly.	• Demonstrate the spacer with a mask or mouthpiece that suits the child's age. • Watch the parent do it. • Give a written asthma action plan.	Technique correct: **goal met**.
Subjective • Father smokes in the house **Objective** • Exposed to dust and smoke	**RISK** **Risk for injury** as evidenced by risk factors: exposure to asthma triggers at home.	Parents describe how they will cut down the triggers.	• No smoking in the house or the car. • Teach how to keep dust down. • Teach the early signs of an attack.	Describe their plan: **goal met**.